

How To Make the Perfect Cappuccino

Prep: 5 mins

Cook: 5 mins

Total: 10 mins

Serving: 1 serving

A Note From Our Recipe Tester

"I had never made a cappuccino before testing this recipe. But, wow, am I glad that I tried it out! The creaminess and balance of the milk, foam, and espresso was just spectacular. I can make this in the comfort of my own home, and it makes my wallet happy, too!" —[Victoria Heydt](#)

Ingredients

For the Espresso

- 2 tablespoons finely ground dark roast coffee
- 4 ounces water

For the Foamed Milk

- 4 ounces milk

Steps to Make It

Pull a Double Shot of Espresso

- 01** Gather the ingredients.
- 02** Pour 4 ounces of water into the boiler of your espresso machine.
- 03** Add 2 tablespoons (or 2 shots) of ground coffee into the portafilter.
- 04** Tamp the coffee down using a tamper, pressing 2 to 3 times to ensure the grounds are packed tightly.
- 05** Insert the portafilter into your espresso machine's group head, locking it in place by turning it to the right.
- 06** Position a demitasse cup or the glass carafe that came with your espresso machine under the group head, and pull the shot for 23 to 30 seconds, or until 2 ounces of espresso are extracted. Typically, there is a lever, switch, or button to start this process.
Once the shot is pulled, foam the milk.

Foam the Milk

- 01** Pour 4 ounces of milk into a glass measuring cup or a small metal pitcher.
- 02** Insert the steam wand into the container, positioning it just below the surface of the milk.
- 03** Engage the steam wand on your espresso machine. You may need to consult your machine's manual, as each espresso maker operates slightly differently.
- 04** Ensure that the tip of the wand is kept toward the side of the container, which helps create a vortex with the milk.
- 05** Move the container higher, lower, closer, and then further away so the steam wand can incorporate air into the milk, creating the foam. The bubbles should gradually become smaller as you do this.
- 06** Once the milk has foamed to double its size, turn the steam wand off.
- 07** Top the espresso with foamed milk right after foaming. When initially poured, a cappuccino consists only of espresso and foam, but the liquid milk quickly settles out of the foam to create the roughly equal parts foam, steamed milk, and espresso for which cappuccino is known.

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Nutrition Facts (per serving)

61

Calories

2g

Fat

6g

Carbs

4g

Protein

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(Nutrition information is calculated using an ingredient database and should be considered an estimate.)